



AFTER

The Confederacy failed to break the blockade. Over the next two months, the *Virginia* made occasional sorties into Hampton Roads, but the epic duel was not repeated.

The *Virginia* was scuttled in May when the advance of Union land forces left it exposed to capture. Never seaworthy, *Monitor* sank on December 31, 1862, while under tow in an Atlantic gale off Cape Hatteras, North Carolina. However, the design spawned a **whole class of vessels**, designated "**monitors**," for use in **inshore and river warfare**. Monitors were still in service up to the 1930s. **Rams and rotating gun turrets** were soon adopted as standard features of warships.

ARMORED VESSELS IN THE WAR

Ironclads and monitors played a major part in later naval actions, including the **struggle for control of the Mississippi** (see [The Fall of New Orleans](#), [David Farragut](#), [Action on the Mississippi River](#) and [The Vicksburg Campaign](#) and the [Battle of Mobile Bay](#)).